

THE KIDS' CHARACTER BACKPACK VAULT™ · BONUS KIT

The Boutique & School-Fair Pitch Kit

sell in sets, not one at a time

Exactly what to say to a kids' boutique or a school-fair organizer, what to charge for 5, 10 and 20 pieces, when to choose consignment or wholesale, and a printable one-page catalog of your 20 character backpacks.

Visit script · Email templates · Price tables in USD · Line sheet · Order form

PRICES IN US DOLLARS · ADJUST TO YOUR OWN YARN COSTS WITH THE FORMULAS INSIDE

How to use this kit

One backpack, one mom, one sale caps you. A boutique or a school fair can take 5, 10 or 20 pieces in a single yes. This kit gives you the words and the numbers so that yes is easy to say — and still profitable for you.

- 1 **Pick your line.** The 20 Vault patterns are grouped into 3 production lines (Quick, Classic, Deluxe) by making time. Bulk orders go to the **Quick line** first: it's where your hours stretch furthest.
- 2 **Make 3 samples** from different lines. You never pitch without a backpack in your hands.
- 3 **Print the one-page catalog** (page 12) and the order form (page 13). Write your prices on them.
- 4 **Choose the channel:** boutique (prices on pages 7-8, consignment vs. wholesale on page 9) or school fair (pages 10-11).
- 5 **Use the script** (pages 4-5), send the email (page 6), follow up on day 5.
- 6 **Take a 50% deposit** on every wholesale or custom order before you buy yarn.

Your 3 production lines

Line	Patterns in the Vault	Making time	Your retail price
Quick	Lucky Ladybug, Little Mouse, Chirpy Chick, Baby Whale, Little Lamb, Honey Bear Cub, Sweet Snail	bulky yarn or S size, 6-9 h	\$65
Classic	Sleepy Sloth, Cheeky Monkey, Moo Moo Cow, Floppy Puppy, Happy Hedgehog, Little Octopus, Little Crab, Little Butterfly	M size, 8-11 h	\$75
Deluxe	Little Llama, Tall Giraffe, Little Hippo, Baby Dragon, Rascal Raccoon	L size or extra details, 9-13 h	\$85

The one rule of pricing to shops

Your **retail price is the same everywhere** — at the fair, on your page, and on the boutique shelf. The boutique buys from you at a wholesale price and sells at your retail price. If you undercut the shop at the school fair, you lose the shop.

At a glance: a 20-piece Quick-line order at \$33 each is a **\$660** invoice with **\$488** left for you after yarn and packaging — from one conversation, with no listing photos, no shipping one parcel at a time and no marketing.

Boutique vs. school fair: who buys what

Kids' boutique / gift shop

- **Wants:** something the big stores don't have, a small range that looks like a collection, reliable delivery.
- **Buys:** 5-10 pieces to test, then reorders by season (back-to-school, holidays, Easter).
- **Pays:** wholesale (you're paid up front) or consignment (paid when it sells).
- **Best sellers for them:** Lucky Ladybug, Little Lamb, Baby Dragon, Floppy Puppy, Chirpy Chick (Easter).
- **Also try:** toy stores, baby-gear shops, children's bookstores, farm shops (Moo Moo Cow, Little Lamb), beach-town gift shops (Baby Whale, Little Crab, Little Octopus).

School fair / PTA bazaar

- **Wants:** a fun stall that raises money for the school and brings parents in.
- **Buys:** nothing directly — you sell at retail to parents and give a booth fee or a % to the school.
- **Pays you:** parents pay full retail, on the spot or with a deposit for a pre-order.
- **Best sellers:** animals in the school colors, sibling sets (see the Sibling Set Pricing Sheet), names embroidered.
- **Also try:** holiday markets at churches and community centers, daycare open days, kids' sports clubs.

What to bring to any pitch

- ☐ 3 finished backpacks from 3 different lines (one Quick, one Classic, one Deluxe)
- ☐ The one-page catalog printed in color (page 12) with your prices written in
- ☐ 2 blank order forms (page 13) and a pen
- ☐ A small yarn card: the color options you can offer, taped yarn snippets
- ☐ A hangtag sample with care instructions: "Spot clean or hand wash cold, lay flat to dry"
- ☐ Your business card or a slip with your shop name — added by you, never inside the PDFs

Safety line for kids' products: for children under 3, embroider the eyes instead of using safety eyes, and never add small loose parts (beads, buttons). Say it in your pitch — shop owners ask, and it shows you're a pro. If you sell in the US at volume, read about the CPSIA rules for children's products before your first big order.

The boutique visit script

Go on a **Tuesday-Thursday, 10-11:30 am**. Never on a Saturday or in the last hour before closing. Walk in as a customer first, look at what they sell and at which price, then ask for the owner.

1 • OPENER (15 SECONDS)

"Hi! I'm [your name], I make handmade crochet character backpacks for kids, right here in [your town]. I love your shop — do you have two minutes? I brought three of them."

2 • PUT THE BACKPACK IN THEIR HANDS

"This is the Lucky Ladybug. Open it — it has a real zipper, adjustable straps with metal sliders, and it holds a lunchbox and a sweater. Each one takes me about seven hours, and every character is my own pattern set, so you won't see them at the mall."

3 • ASK, THEN LISTEN

"What sells best for you for kids aged 3 to 6? ... Do you do a back-to-school or holiday display?"
Listen for: price range on their shelf, season, colors. Write it down in front of them.

4 • MAKE THE OFFER

"The retail price is **\$65-\$85**. For shops I do wholesale from 5 pieces: **\$39** each for 5 Quick-line backpacks, and it goes down with 10 and 20. Or, if you'd rather test first, I can leave 5 on consignment for 90 days."

5 • CLOSE SMALL

"Would you like to start with a trial of 5 — say, the Ladybug, the Lamb and the Dragon? I can deliver in three weeks with a 50% deposit today and the rest on delivery."

If they say...

Objection	What you answer
"It's too expensive."	"The shelf price is \$65 — about what a branded character backpack costs, but this one is handmade and nobody else has it. At \$39 wholesale I still deliver it with hangtag and care card, and you double your money on the shelf."
"We already have backpacks."	"Exactly why these work: they're a gift, not a school supply. They sit in the gift corner, next to the plush toys."
"Leave me your card, I'll think about it."	"Of course. Can I leave one sample for a week? If it doesn't catch eyes, I'll pick it up — no charge."
"Can you make it in our colors?"	"Yes, from 5 pieces per color, at no extra cost. Pick from this yarn card."
"What if they don't sell?"	"Then let's do consignment: you pay nothing now, I restock what sells, and I collect the rest after 90 days."
"Can you do 50 by next month?"	"I can do 20 in about seven weeks with the Quick line. Let's lock 20 now and plan the rest for the next season."

Introduction email & follow-up

Use this when you can't visit, or the day after your visit. Replace everything in pink. Attach 3 photos and the one-page catalog as a PDF. Keep it short — shop owners read on their phone.

SUBJECT

Handmade character backpacks for your kids' corner — 3 photos inside

EMAIL 1 · INTRODUCTION

Hi [owner's first name],

I'm [your name], a local maker in [your town]. I crochet character backpacks for kids aged 2 to 8 — sloths, dragons, ladybugs, lambs and 16 more designs — each with a real zipper and adjustable straps.

I think they'd fit beautifully next to [something they sell: e.g. your plush toys / your back-to-school display]. I've attached 3 photos and a one-page catalog with wholesale prices from 5 pieces. I also offer a 90-day consignment trial if you'd like to test them first.

Could I bring two samples by next [Tuesday or Wednesday] morning? It takes five minutes.

Thank you,

[your name] · [your shop name]

EMAIL 2 · FOLLOW-UP ON DAY 5

Hi [name], just floating this back to the top of your inbox. The [Lucky Ladybug] is the one parents stop for at my fairs — happy to leave one with you for a week so you can see how customers react. Would [day] work?

EMAIL 3 · AFTER A YES

Wonderful — thank you! Here's the order summary: [5] backpacks ([designs and colors]) at [\$39] each, total [\$195]. A 50% deposit of [\$97.50] confirms the order; the rest is due on delivery on [date]. Each piece comes with a hangtag and care card.

EMAIL 4 · REORDER NUDGE (6-8 WEEKS LATER)

Hi [name]! How are the backpacks doing? [Back-to-school / the holidays / Easter] is coming — if you'd like a restock or two new characters for the display, I can have them ready by [date].

Never write "just checking in" or apologize for following up. Always give them one easy next step (a day, a sample, a date).

THE NUMBERS

What to charge for 5, 10 and 20 pieces

Wholesale price per piece = your retail price × **60%** for 5 pieces, **55%** for 10, **50%** for 20. Bigger orders cost you less per piece because you buy yarn in bulk and batch the work (all panels, then all gussets, then all faces).

Line	Retail	5 pieces (60%)	10 pieces (55%)	20 pieces (50%)	Order of 5	Order of 10	Order of 20
Quick	\$65	\$39	\$36	\$33	\$195	\$360	\$660
Classic	\$75	\$45	\$41	\$38	\$225	\$410	\$760
Deluxe	\$85	\$51	\$47	\$43	\$255	\$470	\$860

The margin logic, line by line

Quick line	5 pieces	10 pieces	20 pieces
Wholesale price per piece	\$39	\$36	\$33
Yarn + zipper + hardware + eyes (bulk)	– \$8.50	– \$8.00	– \$7.40
Hangtag, tissue and bag	– \$1.20	– \$1.20	– \$1.20
Your profit per piece	\$29.30	\$26.80	\$24.40
Your profit on the whole order	\$146.50	\$268.00	\$488.00
Making time per piece (batched)	6.5 h	6 h	5.5 h
Profit per hour of work	\$4.51	\$4.47	\$4.44
Delivery time at 20 h/week (+1 week buffer)	3 weeks	4 weeks	7 weeks

Classic line	5 pieces	10 pieces	20 pieces
Wholesale price per piece	\$45	\$41	\$38
Yarn + zipper + hardware + eyes (bulk)	– \$7.60	– \$7.20	– \$6.60
Hangtag, tissue and bag	– \$1.20	– \$1.20	– \$1.20
Your profit per piece	\$36.20	\$32.60	\$30.20
Your profit on the whole order	\$181.00	\$326.00	\$604.00
Making time per piece (batched)	9 h	8.5 h	8 h
Profit per hour of work	\$4.02	\$3.84	\$3.77
Delivery time at 20 h/week (+1 week buffer)	4 weeks	6 weeks	9 weeks

Deluxe line	5 pieces	10 pieces	20 pieces
Wholesale price per piece	\$51	\$47	\$43
Yarn + zipper + hardware + eyes (bulk)	– \$9.50	– \$9.00	– \$8.20
Hangtag, tissue and bag	– \$1.20	– \$1.20	– \$1.20
Your profit per piece	\$40.30	\$36.80	\$33.60
Your profit on the whole order	\$201.50	\$368.00	\$672.00
Making time per piece (batched)	11 h	10.5 h	10 h
Profit per hour of work	\$3.66	\$3.50	\$3.36
Delivery time at 20 h/week (+1 week buffer)	4 weeks	7 weeks	11 weeks

Read this before you say yes

Wholesale pays less per hour than selling one backpack at full price (a Quick-line piece at the fair leaves \$54.80 in 7 h = **\$7.83/h**). What you gain is volume you don't have to find: one conversation replaces 20 separate sales, 20 listings and 20 parcels. That's why bulk orders go to the **Quick line** and full-price sales go to Classic and Deluxe.

Your floor price (never go under it): materials + packaging + (hours × the minimum hourly you accept). Example with a \$4/h minimum on a 20-piece Quick order: \$7.40 + \$1.20 + (5.5 h × \$4) = **\$30.60**. The table price (\$33) is above it. If your minimum is higher, keep the order at 10 pieces (55%) or quote the Classic line at the 5-piece price.

Easy margin boosters: embroidered name **+\$8** (20 minutes) · custom colors free from 5 pieces per color, **+\$6** below that · rush delivery (half the lead time) **+15%** · gift box **+\$4** (costs you about \$1.50).

Consignment vs. wholesale

	Wholesale	Consignment
When you get paid	50% deposit on the order, 50% on delivery	Only when each backpack sells, usually once a month
Your share	50-60% of retail (see price table)	Usually 60% for you / 40% for the shop (some shops 70/30 or 50/50)
Classic backpack, \$75 retail	\$45 at 5 pcs, paid up front	\$45 per piece sold (60%)
Who carries the risk	The shop — it owns the stock	You — unsold pieces come back to you
Who sets the price	The shop (ask them to respect your retail)	You, in the agreement
Paperwork	Order form + invoice	Consignment agreement + inventory list + monthly report
Best for	Shops that already sell handmade; repeat orders	New shops, first contact, testing a new character

How to choose

- **Start with consignment** when the shop hesitates: 5 pieces, 90 days, then convert the best sellers to wholesale.
- **Go straight to wholesale** when the owner asks "what's your wholesale price?" — that's a buyer who already works this way.
- **Never consign more than you can afford to lose.** A good limit: 5-8 pieces per shop, max 2 consignment shops at a time.

Mini consignment agreement (fill in and sign 2 copies)

Maker: _____ Shop: _____ Date: _____

1. The maker leaves the items on the attached inventory list (design, color, retail price) on consignment.
2. The shop sells at the retail price on the list. Discounts only with the maker's written OK.
3. Split on each sale: maker _____% / shop _____%.
4. The shop sends a sales report and pays the maker's share by the _____ of each month.
5. Term: _____ days. After that, the maker collects unsold items or renews.
6. The shop is responsible for items lost, stolen or damaged while in the shop, at the maker's share of the retail price.
7. Either side can end the agreement with 14 days' notice; unsold items are returned to the maker.

Maker signature: _____ Shop signature: _____

Pitching a school fair or PTA bazaar

Fair organizers (PTA/PTO committees, school office, fundraising volunteers) choose stalls 6-10 weeks before the date. Contact them early and make it about the school, not about you.

EMAIL OR NOTE TO THE FAIR ORGANIZER

Hi [organizer's name] ,

I'm [your name] , a [parent at the school / local maker] . I crochet character backpacks for kids and would love a stall at the [fair name] on [date] .

I can offer the school [15% of my sales that day / a \$40 stall fee] , plus one backpack for the raffle. I'll also take pre-orders in the school colors, so parents who miss the day can still order.

Two photos are attached. Is there a stallholder form I can fill in?

Thanks so much,
[your name]

SAY IT IN PERSON (30 SECONDS)

"I make these backpacks — this is the Baby Dragon. I'd like a stall at the fair and give 15% of my sales to the PTA, plus one for the raffle. The kids go crazy for them, so it brings families to the fair."

Booth fee or percentage?

If you expect to sell...	15% of sales costs you	vs. \$40 fee	Choose
3 Quick backpacks (\$195)	\$29.25	\$40.00	Percentage
6 Quick backpacks (\$390)	\$58.50	\$40.00	Flat fee
10 Quick backpacks (\$650)	\$97.50	\$40.00	Flat fee

Rule of thumb: offer the percentage for your first fair (less risk), switch to the flat fee once you know you sell well there.

Your fair-day plan

Stock: 12 backpacks + an order book

Line	Pieces	Which ones
Quick	6	Ladybug, Chick, Mouse, Lamb, Whale, Bear Cub
Classic	4	Puppy, Sloth, Octopus, Butterfly
Deluxe	2	Baby Dragon, Little Llama
Total	12	+ 1 raffle piece (a Quick one)

Price signs (write them big)

- Quick backpacks **\$65** · Classic **\$75** · Deluxe **\$85**
- Name embroidered **+\$8**
- Sibling sets — see the Sibling Set Pricing Sheet
- Pre-order in school colors — 50% deposit, ready in 3 weeks

Display

- ☐ Table cover in cream or white, backpacks standing at kid-eye height on boxes
- ☐ One backpack on a child-size mannequin or chair, zipper open with a lunchbox inside
- ☐ Yarn color card for pre-orders
- ☐ Mirror so kids can try one on
- ☐ Card reader charged + change for cash + receipt book
- ☐ Pre-order sheets on a clipboard (order form, page 13)

What to say at the stall

"Want to try it on? ... That one's the Lucky Ladybug — I can also make it in your school colors with her name on it."

"If you have two, I do a sibling set — they match without being the same."

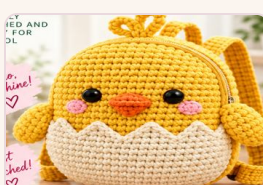
After the fair: send the organizer a thank-you with the amount donated. It gets you invited back — and it's the best reference when you pitch the next school.

Handmade Character Backpacks for Kids

Maker / shop: _____

Crocheted by hand • real zipper • adjustable straps • sizes for ages 2-8

Contact: _____

 Sleepy Sloth M • 25 cm / 9.75 in Classic line • retail \$75	 Little Llama L • 28 cm / 11 in Deluxe line • retail \$85	 Happy Hedgehog Round • 24 cm / 9.5 in Classic line • retail \$75	 Rascal Raccoon M • 25 cm / 9.75 in Deluxe line • retail \$85	 Little Hippo L • 28 cm / 11 in Deluxe line • retail \$85
 Baby Whale M • 25 cm / 9.75 in Quick line • retail \$65	 Little Octopus Round • 24 cm / 9.5 in Classic line • retail \$75	 Baby Dragon M • 25 cm / 9.75 in Deluxe line • retail \$85	 Tall Giraffe L • 28 cm / 11 in Deluxe line • retail \$85	 Cheeky Monkey M • 25 cm / 9.75 in Classic line • retail \$75
 Lucky Ladybug Round • 22 cm / 8.75 in Quick line • retail \$65	 Little Lamb M • 25 cm / 9.75 in Quick line • retail \$65	 Moo Moo Cow M • 25 cm / 9.75 in Classic line • retail \$75	 Floppy Puppy M • 25 cm / 9.75 in Classic line • retail \$75	 Honey Bear Cub S • 22 cm / 8.75 in Quick line • retail \$65
 Little Mouse Round • 22 cm / 8.75 in Quick line • retail \$65	 Chirpy Chick Round • 22 cm / 8.75 in Quick line • retail \$65	 Little Crab Wide • 25 cm / 9.75 in Classic line • retail \$75	 Sweet Snail S • 22 cm / 8.75 in Quick line • retail \$65	 Little Butterfly S • 22 cm / 8.75 in Classic line • retail \$75

Wholesale per piece	5 pcs	10 pcs	20 pcs	Terms
Quick line	\$39	\$36	\$33	50% deposit • balance on delivery
Classic line	\$45	\$41	\$38	Mix designs within a line
Deluxe line	\$51	\$47	\$43	Consignment trial available

Minimum order 5 pieces (designs can be mixed). Custom colors free from 5 pieces per color. Embroidered names +\$8. Delivery 3-11 weeks depending on line and quantity (see order confirmation). Care: spot clean or hand wash cold, lay flat to dry. Under age 3: embroidered eyes available.

Wholesale / consignment order form

Shop: _____ Contact person: _____

Order date: _____ Delivery date: _____ ☐ Wholesale ☐ Consignment (split ____ / ____)

#	Design	Line	Colors	Name / extra	Qty	Price	Total
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							
9							
10							

Total pieces / order total

Payment

Order total: \$ _____

50% deposit received: \$ _____ on

Balance due on delivery: \$ _____

Notes

Hangtags ☐ Gift boxes ☐ Embroidered eyes (under 3) ☐

Maker signature: _____ Shop signature: _____